

IAN HENRY

Seattle, WA | 425-444-7674 | ian@ianhenry.ca

PROFILE

Staff software engineer with 13 years of experience shipping consumer apps at Meta and Microsoft, from zero-to-one launches to products at scale.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Co-founded multiple greenfield initiatives at Meta, driving technical and organizational alignment from ideation to scale, reaching millions of users
- Diverse and deep experience across many languages & frameworks: JavaScript, React, Python, C/C++, PHP/Hack
- Skilled at parachuting into new tech stacks and large legacy codebases, delivering impact quickly
- Brings a measurement-first approach: defines metrics, builds dashboards, and uses data to guide product decisions
- Cultivates cohesive team culture rooted in technical craftsmanship, dedicating time to onboard, mentor and teach engineers across all seniority levels

EXPERIENCE

Meta – Staff Software Engineer

August 2018 - April 2025

Instagram for Oculus

May 2024 - April 2025

- Early member of team building brand new Instagram app for Oculus VR headsets
- Owned most ambiguous and complex features, requiring full-stack expertise across front-end (JavaScript, React Native, GraphQL) and back-end GraphQL and REST APIs in Python
- Onboarded performance and reliability metrics, dashboards, and alerting
- Tech lead for the core app surfaces team post-launch: managed roadmap, scoped feature work, collaborated with PM and design team, onboarded and mentored junior engineers
- Drove UX design independently when designer bandwidth was limited, then partnered with the design team to iterate and implement final Figma specs pixel-perfect

Messenger for iOS & Android

February 2024 - May 2024

- Tech lead for short-term high-priority cross-org initiative tasked with improving media quality for the Messenger mobile apps
- Reverse engineered huge Java, C++ and PHP codebases for Messenger mobile and authored doc summarizing problem domain, technical/architectural overview, workstreams
- Built system to quantify quality of media sent and received via MS-SSIM, and built out roadmap of features to improve quality

Messenger for Desktop, Performance & Reliability

January 2022 - February 2024

- Data, metrics and observability champion: ensured performance and reliability of all features could be quantified and visualized on dashboards
- Solved hardest technical problems requiring deep expertise in JavaScript and C/C++ codebases
- Crash reliability expert: consistently solved obscure crashes and improved reliability of crash reporting infrastructure in JavaScript and C++
- Performance expert: significantly improved speed of core app functionality (app launch, message sending, chat thread loading), leveraging framework and OS tooling
- Release process owner: ensured new product releases maintained a high quality bar
- Onboarded, mentored and taught junior and senior engineers across the org

Messenger for Desktop V2, Product

July 2020 - January 2022

- Product engineer, fully rebuilding Messenger Desktop using React Native (for improved performance and reliability)

- Go-to engineer for the hardest technical problems across the full tech stack, C/C++ and JavaScript
 - Wrote a codegen engine in JavaScript that generates 30k+ lines of C++
 - Data and telemetry infrastructure in JavaScript, C++, PHP/Hack
 - Build/release/continuous integration tooling/automation in PHP/Hack, JavaScript
 - Data and metrics expert, partnering with data science to ensure that the performance and reliability of all features can be quantified and visualized on dashboards
- Tech lead for launch, managed team of 10+ engineers across multiple teams tasked with ensuring engagement metric matched v1: tracked work, ran daily meetings, communicated progress

Messenger for Desktop, Product

August 2018 - July 2020

- Built multiple prototype products on desktop using JavaScript/React and PHP
- Shipped the first version of Messenger for Desktop, built using Electron and React/JavaScript
- Expertise in authentication (single sign-on), Windows push notifications
- Tech lead for launch, for build/release infrastructure, and release process
- Reliability expert, reduced crash rate post-launch by 3x

Microsoft – Software Engineer II

August 2012 - August 2018

Web Services

August 2017 - August 2018

- Built, maintained, and monitored scalable web services for the Universal Store using C# and ASP.NET WebAPI

App Developer

July 2015 - August 2017

- Mobile and desktop developer across a variety of first-party apps.
 - Podcast App: tech lead for brand new app; wrote the design doc, built core parts of the app using XAML and C#, mentored other engineers
 - Groove Music App: implemented features using C#, C++/CX and XAML
 - Office for iOS/Mac: built new features using Objective-C

Operating Systems

August 2014 - June 2015

- Windows Phone mobile engineer, working in C++ and C# across Windows Phone OS codebase

Engineering Systems

August 2012 - April 2014

- Front-end web developer, building applications to manage build and test runs for the Windows Phone OS codebase using ASP.NET MVC, ASP.NET WebAPI, JavaScript, jQuery and CSS

VOLUNTEERING

The Mountaineers

November 2025 - Present

- Implemented various website features and performance improvements requested by trip leaders and members; used AI tools (Cursor) to build with JavaScript & Python in a Plone & Zope based tech stack

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Applied Science in Computer Engineering

2008 - 2012

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada